

Graduate Seminar

An introduction to stochastic calculus with applications to finance and SPDEs

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Stochastic Calculus

In Real Analysis we study measurable functions:

$$f : D \rightarrow R,$$

where both D and R are measurable spaces:

$$(D, \sigma(D), \mu_1) \quad \text{and} \quad (R, \sigma(R), \mu_2).$$

In undergraduate Calculus, we focus only on real valued measurable on $\mathbb{R}^d$:

$$f : D \subseteq \mathbb{R}^d \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d,$$

and the measure space that is implied is the following:

$$(\mathbb{R}^d, \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R}^d), \lambda),$$

where λ is Lebesgue measure.

Stochastic Calculus

When studying Stochastic Calculus, and in general Probability Theory, we consider measurable functions,

$$X : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d,$$

and we consider the measure spaces

$$(\Omega, \mathcal{F}, \mathbb{P}) \quad \text{and} \quad (\mathbb{R}^d, \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R}^d), \lambda),$$

where Ω and $\mathcal{F}$ are referred to as the sample space and set of possible events and

$$\mathbb{P}(\Omega) = 1.$$

Definition (Random Variable)

A measurable function $X : \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d$ is called a $\mathbb{R}^d$ -valued *Random Variable*.

So essentially, Stochastic Calculus and Probability is just Real Analysis on Random Variables.

Stochastic Processes

Definition (Stochastic Process)

A stochastic process is a random variable that is indexed by set, T , which usually represents time:

$$X_t(\omega), \quad t \in T, \omega \in \Omega.$$

One can think a stochastic processes as a two parameter function

$$X_t(\omega) = X(t, \omega) : T \times \Omega \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^d.$$

Definition (Sample Path)

The variable ω represents the idea of a single possible outcome. The following function is then referred to as a *sample path*:

$$t \mapsto X_t(\omega).$$

Examples

Example

Suppose we leave a cup out in the rain. We may model this with a stochastic processes as

$$X_t(\omega) = \text{Amount of rain in the cup at time } t.$$

Since $X_t \geq 0$, maybe we could say that

$$X_t \sim \text{Gamma Distribution with } \mu := \mu(t) \text{ and constant variance } \sigma^2$$

If the rain is constant then it makes sense for the variance to be constant. Moreover, as time continuous, there will be more water in the cup on average, so the mean should be a function in time.

Brownian Motion.

Brownian motion is a very widely used stochastic processes. We will construct Brownian motion through a random walk.

Theorem

Consider a random walk $X = \{X_0 = 0, X_{t_1}, \dots, X_{t_n}\}$. Suppose that for $k \in \{1, \dots, n\}$ that

$$\mathbb{P}[X_{t_k} = -h] = \mathbb{P}[X_{t_k} = h] = 1/2.$$

and suppose that the time increments are all constant:

$$t_k - t_{k-1} = d \quad \forall k \in \{1, \dots, n\}.$$

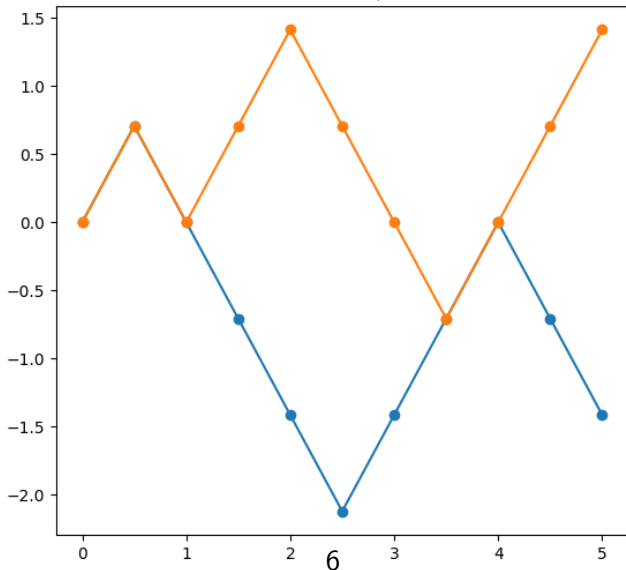
Suppose that $h^2 = d$. Now define

$$B_n(t_k) = \sum_{i=0}^k X_{t_i}.$$

Then B_n converges to a Brownian motion.

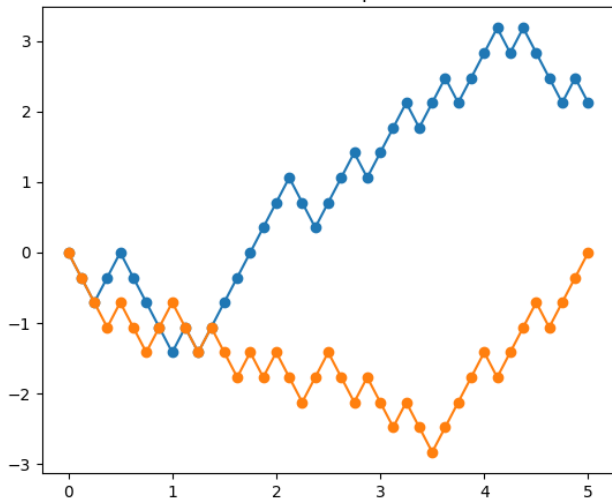
Random Walk Example

2 sample paths of a random walk
jump size = 0.707 and step size = 0.5
number of steps = 10



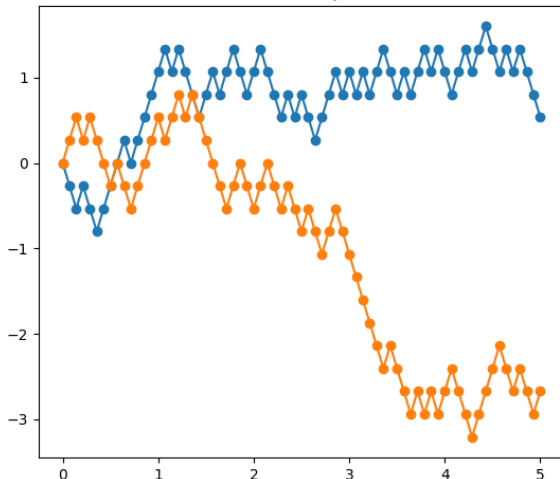
Random Walk Example

2 sample paths of a random walk
jump size = 0.354 and step size = 0.125
number of steps = 40

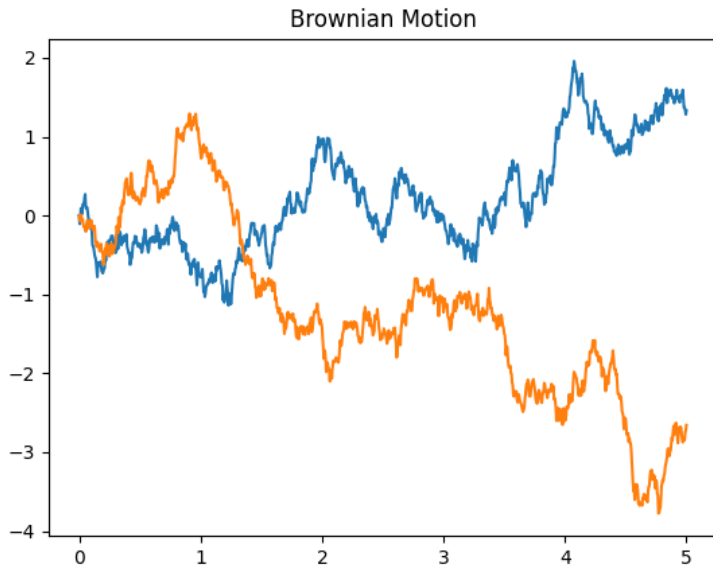


Random Walk Example

2 sample paths of a random walk
jump size = 0.267 and step size = 0.07
number of steps = 70



Random Walk Example



The Ito integral (special case)

Suppose that f is a continuous function with bounded variation. Then we can define:

$$\int_0^t f(s)dB_s(\omega) := \lim_{\|P\| \rightarrow 0} \sum_{i \in P} f(t_{i-1})(B_t(\omega) - B_{t_{i-1}}(\omega)),$$

where $P = t_0 = 0, t_1, t_2, \dots, t_n = t$ is a partition of $[0, t]$. In other words, the Ito integral in this case the left point Riemann sum.

Theorem (Ito's Formula)

If f is twice continuously differentiable then we have the following "Fundamental Theorem of Ito Calculus"

$$\int_a^t \frac{d}{ds} f(B_s) dB_s = f(B_t) - f(B_a) - \frac{1}{2} \int_a^t \frac{d^2}{ds^2} f(B_s) ds.$$

Example

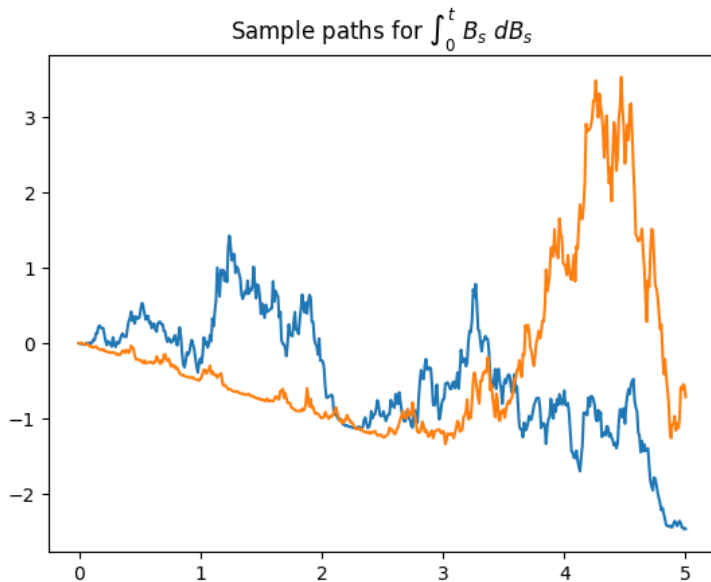
If we apply the above to $f(x) = x^2/2$ with $a = 0$ then we have

$$\int_0^t B_s dB_s = \frac{B_t^2}{2} - \frac{t}{2},$$

which is close but not quite the same thing as

$$\int_0^t x dx = \frac{t^2}{2}$$

Two sample paths



Why do we care about Brownian Motion? An application to finance.

Consider a stock that has value S_t at time t . Consider $t = 0$ to be the point of entry into the investment. We can define a return rate as follows:

$$S_t = S_0(1 + R_t), \quad R_t := \frac{S_t - S_0}{S_0} \text{ is the return rate over the period } [0, t].$$

We want to make predictions of our return. In a very simple model, we can assume that

$$R_t \sim \text{Normal}(\mu t, \sigma^2), \quad \mu \in \mathbb{R}, \sigma \in (0, \infty).$$

In terms of Stochastic Calculus, we express this as the following stochastic differential equation:

$$R_t = \frac{dS_t}{S_t} = \mu dt + \sigma dB_t, \quad \text{where } B_t \text{ is a Brownian motion.}$$

Modeling a stock price with geometric brownian motion

The notation

$$dS_t = \mu S_t dt + \sigma S_t dB_t, \quad \text{where } B_t \text{ is a Brownian motion}$$

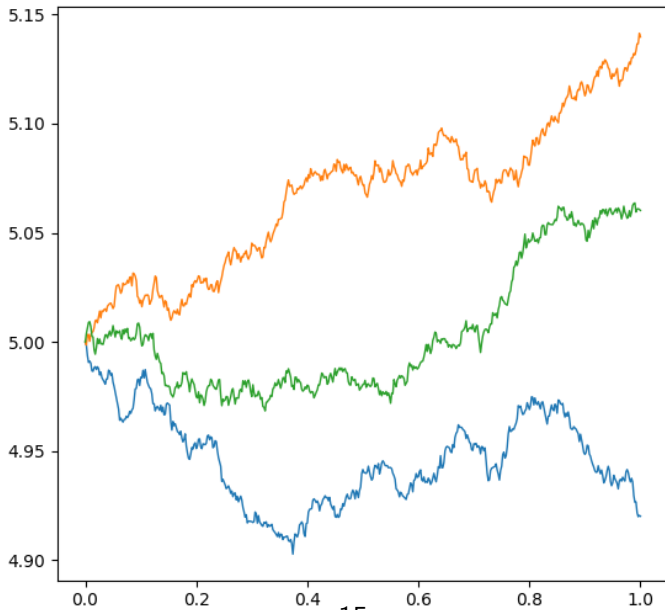
is only symbolic as dB_t does not exist. The above can be legitimately viewed as the following integral equation:

$$S_t - S_0 = \int_0^t \mu S_k dk + \int_0^t \sigma S_k dB_k.$$

The stochastic processes S_t that solves the above equation is called a Geometric Brownian Motion. Notice that we have come up with a random variable that models the stock price:

$$S_t(\omega) = S_0 + \int_0^t \mu S_k(\omega) dk + \int_0^t \sigma S_k dB_k(\omega).$$

Geometric Brownian Motion: $dX_t = \sigma X_t dW_t + \mu X_t dt$
(a, b) = (0, 1), $X_a = 5$, $\sigma = 0.01$, and $\mu = 0.001$
we subdivide the domain $n = 500$ times



Black-Scholes option pricing model for European calls

Suppose at time $t = 0$ you buy a contract from a seller, allowing you to purchase 1 share of a stock at time $t = T$ and a set price of K , regardless if what the stock price at time T is.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Payout and time } T &= \begin{cases} S_T - K & \text{if } S_T > k \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \\ &= (S_T - K)^+\end{aligned}$$

What is a fair price for the this contract?

For this we need a to create a self-financing strategy.

We assume that the stocks price follows a geometric Brownian motion,

$$dS_t = \mu S_t dt + \sigma S_t dB_t.$$

Let a_{t_i} be the amount of shares owned over the period $t \in (t_{i-1}, t_i]$. Then at any time $t \in [0, T]$, the amount of shares owned is

$$a_t = \sum_{i=1}^n a_{t_i} \mathbf{1}_{(t_{i-1}, t_i]}(t)$$

and the realized over $[0, T]$

$$\begin{aligned} a_T S_T - a_0 S_0 &= \sum_{i=1}^n a_{t_i} (S_{t_i} - S_{t_{i-1}}) = \int_0^T a_t dS_t \\ &= \mu \int_0^T a_t S_t dt + \sigma \int_0^T a_t S_t dB_t \end{aligned}$$

Summarizing the last slide...

$$\text{Our stock profit on time } [0, T] = \underbrace{a_T S_T - a_0 S_0 = \int_0^T a_t \, dS_t}$$

Now suppose we also invest in a bond with interest rate, r , that has price β_t at time t . Similarly...

$$\text{Our bond profit on time } [0, T] = \underbrace{b_T S_T - b_0 S_0 = \int_0^T b_t \, d\beta_t}$$

Definition (Self Financing Strategy)

A pair of stocks and bonds, (a, b) , is self financing if

$$a_T S_T + b_T S_T = a_0 S_0 + b_0 S_0 + \int_0^T a_t \, dS_t + \int_0^T b_t \, d\beta_t$$

Fair price for a European call option

A fair price for a European call option that allows the buyer to buy 1 share at price K at time T regardless of the price of the stock S_T at time T is the amount one would need to invest in a self financing strategy,

$$\underbrace{a_T S_T + b_T S_T}_{V_T} = \underbrace{a_0 S_0 + b_0 S_0}_{V_0} + \int_0^T a_t dS_t + \int_0^T b_t d\beta_t,$$

such that the value of the strategy at time T is equal to $(S_T - K)^+$:

$$V_T = (S_T - K)^+$$

Let $f(S_t, T - t) = V_t$. So we see that

$$f(S_T, 0) = V_T = (S_T - K)^+ \quad \text{and} \quad f(S_0, T) = V_0$$

So we need to find f . Moreover, $f(S_0, T)$ is the fair price to pay.

It can be shown that f solves the following partial differential equation

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial f}{\partial s}(s, x) = \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2 x^2 \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2}(s, x) + rx \frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(s, x) - rf(s, x) & (s, x) \in [0, T] \times (0, \infty) \\ f(0, x) = (x - K)^+ & x \in (0, \infty). \end{cases}$$

The solution is given by

$$f(t, x) = x\Phi(g(t, x)) - Ke^{-rt}\Phi(h(t, x)),$$

where

$$g(t, x) = \left[\ln\left(\frac{x}{K}\right) + \left(r + \frac{1}{2}\sigma^2\right)t \right] / (\sigma\sqrt{t}),$$

and

$$h(t, x) = g(t, x) - \sigma/\sqrt{t},$$

and

$$\Phi(t) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int_0^t \exp\left(-\frac{|x|^2}{2}\right) dx$$

References